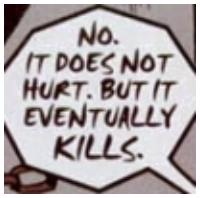
If you controlled Dark Eras 2...



Malkydel
Member

Join Date: Jan 2015
Posts: 112

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07-01-2015, 08:44 AM #31

*Originally posted by **The Kings Raven***
What are you thinking for this group? Hunting Style? Endowment? How did or didn't mundane political changes affect them?

Hunting Style, for the time, I was thinking they'd be quite straight forward sorts. Maybe some sort of ceremonial claymore or pike. A bit of low level formation work. This was all just general head-chatter when they first proposed a Scottish Wars of Independence Era. If they had an Endowment, as a Conspiracy, I'd think some sort of elemental 'one with with nation' type approach. Obviously, at the time, they're focussed on protecting their country. They're as much fighting the war as they are upholding the Vigil. There'd be a nice balance of "Well, these are our mortal concerns, but on the other hand even a Scotsman can be an abomination."

So there's that double edged sword, almost fighting a battle that they realise is actually a self-deception.

"The phrase 'flies on the heads of pins' appeared 43 times in that journal, sometimes in the middle of sentences or written in the margins."

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07-01-2015, 03:26 PM #32

So, crossover pitches to go with my core 11...

Vampire/Beast: Jazz Age (Lovecraftian Racism cast against the intrigue of the



glamourweaver
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 7541

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Harlem Renaissance & the rise of organized crime via bootlegging under Prohibition)

Hunter/Mummy: Book of Judges (defend the Children of Israel from the corruption of the Cults of Foreign Gods!)

Mage/Geist: Golden Age of Piracy (the Nassau conflict with the Thearchs & Seers is central)

Demon/Promethean: Mansa Musa Pilgrimage (are the angelic visions seemingly stalking the journey the God Machine or Qashmallim?)

Werewolf/Changeling: Meiji Restoration

ALTERNATIVES

Mage/Changeling - Arturian Britain (the mortal side of events and setting are historically accurate to 6th Century Britain, but the supernatural side of things has seeds of the later legends)

Vampire/Hunter - 1830s-1850s India (expanding the Southern City Alliance setting and the Caste associated Bloodlines of Indian Kindred society, while Hunters arise among the NOT TEMPLE OF DOOM-LIKE "Thuggee" of the era that caps with the Rebellion of 1857)

Hunter/Demon - Albigensian Crusade (Hunter focus on the era's dominant Western European Conspiracy, the Papal sanctioned "Red Crusade" who wield Saintly relics against demonic presence [at this point the Order of the Knights of Saint George are a secretly heretical British arm of the Crusade], and the Bon Hommes compact, who are Cathars seeking to combat the ***machinations*** [lol... get it? GET IT?] of the Demiurge, and thus find their "Aeons", enemies of the material-world-Demiurge, are the same beings the Roman Church Hunters consider "Demons")

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

👍 6

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07-01-2015, 04:02 PM #33

Arcanist
Member

Join Date: Oct 2014
Posts: 1232

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Arthurian Britain? Yes please! Finally getting to see pre-Archmage, or even post Archmage, Merlin? Was Lailoken another name for Merlin, or was he a Changeling who founded the Eldritch Order? Is it possible for both to be the right answer? Is Morganna a Scelestus, just a powerful Mage opposed to Merlin, or a True Fae? Was Arthur or any of the 'knights' a Hero?

Also, it would be criminal not to have Y Ddraig Goch not incorporated somehow.

Book of Judges Mummy/Hunter sounds like a good combination. Throw that in with Biblical Demon and maybe some Promethean. Let's see two different 'Gods' work side-by-side while the distinctly different Mummies set up in the middle.

My Homebrew Hub

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CatDoom
Member

Join Date: Jun 2014
Posts: 370

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07-02-2015, 01:52 AM #34

Lemme see...

Vampire: late 1940's Los Angeles - the Golden Age of Hollywood meets the cynical crime fiction of Raymond Chandler. Crossover setting with Mage Noir.

Werewolf: The Overland Trail - native and Anglo packs clash as the westward expansion of the US population causes massive disruptions of the ecology on both sides of the gauntlet

Mage: Renaissance Italy - an early predecessor to the Free Council emerges in the form of Mages who embrace renaissance humanism and art

Promethean: The Eastern Front in World War II - striving to find humanity in the face of unimaginable suffering and death

Changeling: Merovingian France - sort of a counterpoint to *Lily, Saber, and Thorn*, this is another era of tangled alliances and larger-than-life characters, but with a more brutal edge

Hunter: The Achaemenid Empire - Persian hunters do battle with the demons and sorcerers that prey on the diverse cultures of the empire. Possibly a crossover with Immortals; I have an idea for a group of Purified Zoroastrian demon hunters.

Geist: The End of the Aztecs - war and disease ravage a conquered land, as religions clash and ancient traditions adapt to changing times

Mummy: Inca Empire - I agree this would be really cool

Not sure about Beast or Demon...

Last edited by CatDoom; 07-02-2015, 02:03 AM.

1 Quote Flag



glamourweaver
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 7541

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07-04-2015, 08:58 AM #35

> *Originally posted by* ***Arcanist***
> *Arthurian Britain? Yes please! Finally getting to see pre-Archmage, or even post Archmage, Merlin? Was Lailoken another name for Merlin, or was he a Changeling who founded the Eldritch Order? Is it possible for both to be the right answer? Is Morganna a Scelestus, just a powerful Mage opposed to Merlin, or a True Fae? Was Arthur or any of the 'knights' a Hero?*

Morganna is of the Daione Legacy (though in close league with Changelings) trying to drag down the narrative Merlyn was weaving into tragedy of the hubris of man and justice for what happened to her mother. Nimue I'd make fae (either True or Changeling, I'm not sure yet). I considered making Morganna a

Post

Changeling, but her being Merlyn's pupil is actually an element I really like some of the lore.

> *Book of Judges Mummy/Hunter sounds like a good combination. Throw that in with Biblical Demon and maybe some Promethean. Let's see two different 'Gods' work side-by-side while the distinctly different Mummies set up in the middle.*

A little early for Promethean in Judaic Lore - I was going to use them for a Babylonian Captivity era, specifically incorporating the creation of the first Unfleshed Golem under the influence of the Babylonian Tammuz. Possibly a crossover era with Vampire, building on the material in Ancient Bloodlines/Mysteries.

The Principle v. God Machine dynamic was central to my Mansa Musa Pilgrimage pitched era.

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

2

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glamourweaver
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 7541

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07-11-2015, 12:45 AM #36

> *Originally posted by **glamourweaver***
>
> *Beast: Turn of the Century Tibet/Mongolia (contemporary to Ruins of Empire, with the decaying Chinese power, Russian expansion, and British adventurism during the reign of the 13th Dalai Lama)*

As much as I love East Asia of the "Ruins of Empire" era as a subject worth exploring, and think that the whole turn of the century world is perfect for a massive crossover setting (the Great Refusal just happened and the Free Council is forming, while warring against the Seers of the Throne! Just one off hand thing the era's got going on, beyond the subject matters already discussed) - I think for a normal length, single gameline era, this slot can be put to better use.

I'm revising my original rundown, to give Beast the Paleolithic Era!

So if, I had the godlike powers to command equal length sequels to Dark Eras be published with my selection of eras, despite the fact that in reality it only got to the size it did because of the draw of participation to shape it - this is what I'd do... in chronological order:

- Paleolithic Beast
- Book of Judges Hunter/Mummy
- Qin Dynasty Vampire (+ 5K on Immortals)
- Fall of the Mayan Empire Mage
- Founding of the Haudenosaunee Hunter
- Dante's Italy Geist (+5K on Inferno)
- Mansa Musa Pilgrimage Demon/Promethean
- Height of the Incan Empire Mummy
- English Civil War-The Great Fire Promethean
- Golden Age of Piracy Mage/Geist
- Underground Railroad Changeling (+10K to extend involved Hedge paths

through Brazil and Dahomey, with the relevant Changeling Courts)
- Wild West Demon
- Great War Werewolf (+5K for some Geist goodies too; I'm thinking the Horsemen themselves are at least rumored antagonists who may be in play)
- Jazz Age Vampire/Beast
- 2150 Demon (+10K to revise Bleeding Edge to Second Edition)
- 3473 Mummy, the Fifth Turn (+10K to revise Infinite Macabre to Second Edition)

And the Companion 2....

- Vedic India Demon
- Babylonian Captivity Vampire/Promethean
- Arthurian Britain Mage/Changeling
- Cathar France Hunter/Demon
- Ivan the Terrible's Russia Werewolf
- French Revolution Mage
- British India through the Mutiny Vampire/Hunter
- Meiji Restoration Werewolf/Changeling
- Klondike Gold Rush Geist
- Innocents in the Blitz

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

👍 2

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glamourweaver
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 7541

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07-11-2015, 12:51 AM #37

> *Originally posted by* ***CatDoom***
>
> *Hunter: The Achaemenid Empire - Persian hunters do battle with the demons and sorcerers that prey on the diverse cultures of the empire. Possibly a crossover with Immortals; I have an idea for a group of Purified Zoroastrian demon hunters.*

I should note that Herodetus' "Immortals" are probably a misconstruing of Anûšiya (Companions - they were the bodyguards of the Emperor) as Anauša (literally Non-Death).

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

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07-11-2015, 02:50 AM #38

> *Originally posted by* ***glamourweaver***
>
> *I should note that Herodetus' "Immortals" are probably a misconstruing*

CatDoom
Member

Join Date: Jun 2014
Posts: 370

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of Anûšiya (Companions - they were the bodyguards of the Emperor) as Anauša (literally Non-Death).

I knew that, actually, but the idea of "Persian Immortals" is one deeply ingrained in the western popular consciousness, so it would be a shame not to do anything with it. That said, these hunters wouldn't have any connection with the historical Anûšiya.

My idea involves them practicing a variant of the Haoma ritual which culminates in the creation of an elixir bestowing Purification. This substance would correspond with the Immortality-granting "White Hom" mentioned in the *Zadspram*, and the process of producing an elixir tailored for the individual seeking Purification would be analogous to the story of Zarathustra's conception given in the *Denkard*, in which the prophet's frawahr (a being sort of like a guardian angel) is sent down from heaven within a unique hom-plant to be united on earth with his mortal body.

Both of these texts post-date the Acaemenid period by a considerable length of time, but in the World of Darkness they might have drawn inspiration from the Purification ritual, rather than the other way around.

My current idea is that the Purified Persian Daeva-hunters (who I'm tentatively calling the Ashavan) are one of two supernaturally empowered groups of Persian hunters. The others are the Vidaeva who, like the Otodo in the upcoming Edo dark era, share an origin with the Lucifuge. My idea is that they believe themselves to be descendants of the Usij, ancient enemies of Zarathustra who consorted with the Daevas. The Vidaeva have turned away from their accursed heritage and seek to channel the baleful powers they've inherited to constructive ends through the use of ceremonies dedicated to various Yazatas.

While the Ashavan focus their efforts on protecting the material world from baleful spirits and, to a lesser extent, do battle with werewolves, mages, and others who consort with those spirits, the Vidaeva focus on battling cultists and sorcerers, and exorcising and banishing demons that have entered the physical world. They also incinerate the odd vampire from time to time, usually one that's masquerading as a deity or has otherwise built up a cult around itself.

"Foreign" hunter conspiracies would be present in the Empire as well, including early versions of the Aegis Kai Doru, the Ascending Ones, and the Faithful of Shulpae. Compacts I'd have to build from the ground up, since those don't tend to have the same kind of ancient pedigree that many of the Conspiracies have.

Last edited by CatDoom; 07-11-2015, 02:56 AM.

1
Quote Flag



Hackthulhu
Member

Join Date: Apr 2015
Posts: 73

07-11-2015, 02:24 PM #39

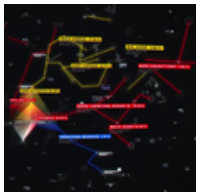
- Vampire: The Civil War, Abraham Lincoln, an avowed and potent vampire hunter has taken the reins of power, Jefferson Davis is a Ghoul of the Invictus Elder who had been running DC and the country behind the scene, who in response to the election of a hunter has decided to revolt against the union and put down this little "american problem" turns out, Lincoln is ready for the fight...
- Werewolf: Gold Rush; California, once a refuge for spirits and nature is being invaded by thousands of new people, turning the spirit courts on their heads. People coming in from everywhere is leading to a new borderlands, and the spirits are not happy about this change-up...

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- Mage: Fear and Loathing in the Summer of Love: the countercultural rise and the rise of spirituality and the movement of human potential portents the rise of the free council and its distancing from the diamond orders... but the seers are always watching, biding their time, waiting to strike at a disorganized mob...
- Promethian: 2020: The rise of wearable technology has humans trying to make themselves less human and more artifical, what does it mean to be a golem trying to find your humanity when all the humans around you want to be more like you...
- Changeling: Behind the Iron Curtain; Once escaping from arcadia and the insane demands of their keepers, Changlings return to a world of secrets, lies, and dystopian insanity, but this time, its all on the humans side...
- Hunter: See Vampire: The Civil War, Hunter: WWII or Hunter: USA Counter-Culture all of these are good, honestly, you put hunter anywhere and anytime and i like it..
- Geist: The Black Death. Pestilence and death is everywhere, so why did you survive, and what are you going to do now that you have?
- Mummy: The Global War On Terror; The chaos in the region really all started when the taliban destroyed an ancient relic that was thought to be a buddah, it was really a gate from Irem, the energies that it unleashed swept through the region and have started to warp the ancient lands into something new, if only the little humans could see...
- Demon: Good Night and Good Luck; McCarthy is the head of a powerful God Machine Cult that has begun to search heavily for Demons under the guise of rooting out communism
- Beast: A Nuclear Family: WW2 is over and people are trying to get back to their lives, But the horrors they saw in war have opened pathways to the primordial dream...

I tried to keep things more modern (as people had seemed to suggest) and honestly i am not particularly familiar with promethian, mummy or geist, but this was a pretty fun list to draw up...

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Agentwestmer
Member

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 394

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07-12-2015, 12:18 AM #40

Demon: Istanbul in the Second World War

Geist: the Spanish Civil War

Beast: The Russio-Finnish Winter War

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07-12-2015, 03:19 AM #41

I shall suggest Renaissance werewolf/mage. Between the Duchess of Malfi and Rodrigo López , who was the inspiration for the wolf metaphor filled Shylock from the merchant of vinice (and who I believe was trying to woo the queen Elizabeth



The young man in the cafe
Member

Join Date: Sep 2014
Posts: 1097

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rather than poison her), It seems that the blood of the wolf runs through the noble families of Europa and the Ivory Claws are nearing civil war as they compete for mates of power and the forsaken howl at the gates to the palace. Speaking of Shakespeare, the occult symbolism of his plays and those of his contemplates suggests to many awakened that the plays themselves may be some from of ritual meant to effect all the supernaturals of europe, but to what end? The awakened scramble to discover what the playwrights are planning.

Basically an expansion for Requiem for Regina that gives some political stories to werewolf (seriously, look into the drama and skullduggery surrounding the Lopez incident) and gives magi a chance to find out the occult truths behind Shakespeare and co's plays.

And just so you know, Lopez is cognate for the Spanish/Portuguese word for wolf, so combined with the wolf metaphors used with Shylock and it becomes pretty obvious what that guy was in the Wod... come to think of it, wasn't that guy who claimed down syndrome was the inspiration for werewolf legends named Lopez? 😉

Last edited by The young man in the cafe; 07-12-2015, 05:10 PM.

Despite the user name I am actually bigender.

My Savannah Setting for CofD can be found here

My heroes as monster tamers rules for BtP can be found here

👍 2

Quote Flag



glamourweaver
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 7541

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07-12-2015, 11:48 PM #42

One thing I'd want to play with in Dark Eras, is while being true to history as possible in the mortal sphere, draw on certain historic myths as rooted in the supernatural world.

For example, in 855, during the reign of Pope Benedict III, the leader of the Rome Consilium was a male presenting leader of a Christian sect of Mages, who was assigned-female-at-birth and bore a child as Hierarch. Thus "Pope Joan" has "her" (actually his, the Hierarch would be called a trans man in our time) basis in the supernatural world. I imagine his Gnostic Christian regional Order, is claimed by both the Paternoster Ministry and the Italian Silver Ladder as their predecessor.

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

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01-14-2016, 08:46 PM #43



atamajakki
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 5487

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Sorry for the necro, but I can't get America during the Vietnam War as a Mage setting out of my head.

Thematically, it's a direct progression from Mage Noir - America is awakened, messily and painfully, to the horrors of war, the inequalities that run so deep, and the infallibility (if not outright cruelty!) of those who rule - and is left with a whole lot of painful truth it didn't really want to find. Kids are snatched out of high school and sent to kill and die in a godforsaken jungle halfway across the world, and the few who make it back have to deal with the twin pains of psychological scars and a nation that doesn't know how to take them back. Racial tensions are polarized between stunning, stirring marches and armed self-defense movement, while the conservative, Christian culture of the United States is challenged by cheap drugs, free love, and a New Age search for answers that tradition doesn't seem to have. The government has a trigger finger resting on nuclear armageddon and who knows how many black budgets mixed up in shit like mind control and extrasensory perception.

At the end of the decade, a man sets foot on the moon.

It's one hell of a time for the Awakened. The Diamond Orders see their reflections in the world of Sleepers, and they don't like what they see; the Arrows have to confront the hellish truth of war and conflict, the Ladder has to wonder who they really want raised up in their social hierarchy, the Guardians watch an alphabet soul of liars in suits wear more masks than they ever have, and the Mysterium have to wonder if their secrets have any value to the normal people so desperately looking for meaning. For the Free Council, there's potential revolutions on every side - social, racial, spiritual, sexual - and no one can agree on how the fuck to make any of it finally happen. The Seers watch as humanity spins deeper into mimicry of their masters, reveling in war and division and false paths to enlightenment... and realize they've lost control of the reins.

What good is magic when it can't save the guy next to you in the chopper? What does Supernal truth matter when there's an entire shade of people who live without voices? What can the Awakened do to save a world burning down around them, and what is their role in a country changing faster than anyone can control?

Remi. she/her. game designer.

2

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01-14-2016, 09:06 PM #44

Charlaquin
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 10831

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> *Originally posted by **glamourweaver***
> *Mage/Changeling - Arturian Britain (the mortal side of events and setting are historically accurate to 6th Century Britain, but the supernatural side of things has seeds of the later legends)*

Oh my god, I am in love with this pitch.

Going by Willow now, or Wil for short. She/Her/Hers.

Quote Flag



ArcaneArts
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 11382

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01-14-2016, 10:43 PM #45

If I controlled Dark Eras two, I'd lock myself in a cabin with tons of history books, no internet, and stay there a month until I came up with eleven unique and interesting settings without the influence of other people.

And then I'd eat a goat.

Kelly R.S. Steele, Freelance Writer(Feel free to call me Kelly, Arcane, or Arc)
The world is not beautiful, therefore it is.-Keiichi Sigsawa, Kino's Journey
Feminine pronouns, please.

3 Quote Flag

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